STATION 4 HELPER GM — THE MIMIC MENAGERIE (WANDS & KEYS)

Pair: Scooby-Doo (Barbarian) & Murray Mummy (Druid) · **Goal:** test four identical keys with four wands and lift the real one with Mage Hand → **Crest #4 + Evidence Card E4**. **Target:** 10–15 min. Full rules: `Stations/Station_4_Mimic_Menagerie_Wands_and_Keys.md`.

Before the players arrive

- Four **identical** alcove cards, Alcove I–IV. Four wand cards; a **purple bead on Poison** and a **green bead on Acid** (one charge each).
- Reveal tiles (Illusion Dispelled, Mimic, Disarmed Construct) face down in your box. The Menagerie plaque (Envelope 3) face down under the wand rack.
- Shuffle Tracker on your clipboard with a **paperclip on the starting layout**. **A real snack for Scooby; check allergies.** Phone timer.

Your special job: the shuffle and the wands

- **Collect the bead before narrating.** The moment a player fires Poison or Acid, hold out your hand for the bead.
- **Read the matrix wording exactly.** Identical outcomes get identical words, so plain results are clues too.
- **A wrong key lifted** (by hand, mage hand, whip, or a thrown object) triggers that alcove, then **reset**: read the reset line, move the paperclip **A → B → C → D → A**, clear all reveal tiles, return both beads.

> Reset line: "With a grinding roar, the four arches spin like a roulette wheel and lock back into place. Whatever you learned, it's scrambled now. Two fresh gems click into the wand cradles."

Layout	Alcove I	Alcove II	Alcove III	Alcove IV
A	Illusion	Mimic	Construct	**Real**
B	**Real**	Construct	Illusion	Mimic
C	Construct	**Real**	Mimic	Illusion
D	Mimic	Illusion	**Real**	Construct

Wand reaction matrix (say these words exactly)

Content	Bright Light	Poison (1 charge)	Acid (1 charge)	Mage Hand (lifts)
Illusion	Shadow stays frozen. **Reveal.**	"The mist drifts straight *through* the key." **Reveal.**	"The acid passes through and hisses on the wall behind." **Reveal.**	Gong, cold vapour. **Reset.**
Mimic	"Its shadow swings with the beam."	Gags and slumps into a grey blob. **Reveal.**	"The acid splashes over the key and hisses on the pedestal. The key looks unharmed."	Bites, lunges. **Reset.**
Construct	"Its shadow swings with the beam."	"The mist beads on the metal and drifts away."	Casing melts, fuse dies. **Reveal (disarmed).**	Armed: explodes, **reset**. After Acid: harmless scrap; no reset, not the real key.
Real key	"Its shadow swings with the beam."	"The mist beads on the metal and drifts away."	"The acid splashes over the key and hisses on the pedestal. The key looks unharmed."	**Success!**

STATION 4 HELPER GM — RUNNING THE ROOM

Station clock

Time	Do this
0:00	Read the Player Introduction aloud. Start the timer.
2:00–3:00	**Envelope 1** when they look around, or someone reaches for a key with no plan.
5:00–6:00	**Envelope 2**: toss Scooby a real snack if he hasn't used Snack Surge.
8:00–9:00	**Envelope 3** on a wand-rack search (Investigation DC 10), or reveal it at 9:00.
11:00	Stuck, or a reset after 10:00: **Envelope 4**.
13:00	Not solved: the real key starts to glow faintly.
15:00	Lead GM's bell = hard stop. Then **Envelope 5** and send them to the Gate.

Hazards (scaled for teens)

- **Mimic** (AC 12, 15 HP): one bite at whoever disturbed it, +5 to hit, **1d8+2 piercing + 2 acid** (it crunches a mage hand instead and gets no bite). Then Murray's Shuffle and Scooby's bites finish it, then **reset**.
- **After Acid:** construct is harmless, including Mage Hand; door rejects it without a reset. A room reset rearms it.
- **Armed construct:** everyone within 30 ft makes a **DC 12 Dex save, 2d4** damage, half on a save. Then **reset**.
- **Illusion:** a gong, no damage. **Reset.**

Character rulings

- **Scooby, Scooby Snack Surge** (needs a real snack): +14 Perception vs **DC 17** (1–2 fail; 3–20 succeed). Failed sniff: surge spent, no location/false clue, no reset. Scooby asks **one** question: *"alive?"* (finds the mimic) or *"fake?"* (finds the illusion). After a reset, only DC 15 without a surge, unless you give a mercy snack.
- **Murray, Sandstorm Shuffle** (Action): automatically restrains the mimic for 2 rounds.
- **Murray, Nature DC 10:** *"Mimics digest with acid. Acid won't bother one, but poison makes them gag."*
- **Murray, Bandage Whip** (reach 2 squares): lifting a key counts as Mage Hand. **Tapping a pedestal** (not the key) is safe and gives that alcove's Envelope 4 sound.

Nudges (questions only)

- About to grab a key: *"Does anything here tell you what happened to the last people?"*
- Zapping at random: *"What question does each wand answer?"*
- Forgot the charges: *"Anything printed on the wand cards you haven't used?"*
- Ignoring Scooby: *"Scooby, your stomach just growled."*
- Two keys left, no charges: *"Anything either of you can do that isn't a wand?"*

Don't

- Don't hint at any alcove, and keep a straight face when they point at the real one.
- Don't put a reveal tile or the mimic standee out until it's earned.
- Don't call them "the mimic wand" or "the bomb wand"; use the wand names.

Reward (Envelope 5)

Hand over **Crest #4** and **Evidence Card E4**: *"Take these to the Grand Gate!"*

STATION 4 — ENVELOPE LABELS

ENVELOPE 1 · LOOK AROUND

Station 4 · Menagerie. Open at **2–3 min**, or when someone reaches for a key with no plan.

ENVELOPE 2 · YOUR SHEET

Station 4 · Menagerie. Open on **Scooby Snack Surge** (5–6 min). Bring a real snack!

ENVELOPE 3 · THE RULE

Station 4 · Menagerie. Open on a wand-rack search (DC 10), or at **9:00**.

ENVELOPE 4 · SEALED: EMERGENCY

Station 4 · Menagerie. **Helper only.** At 11:00 if stuck, or after a reset past 10:00.

ENVELOPE 5 · REWARD

Station 4 · Menagerie. Open on solve: **Crest #4 + Evidence Card E4**.

ENVELOPE CONTENTS

ENVELOPE 1 · THE SCORCHED FLOOR (READ ALOUD)

> Just past the line of brass studs, the floor is scorched in a black fan shape: deep tooth gouges in the flagstones and a dried, sticky puddle. Nothing like that is on your side of the line. The wand cradles are worn smooth. Two of them have a single socket where a charge-gem sits.

ENVELOPE 2 · SCOOBY SNACK SURGE (READ ALOUD)

Roll d20 +14 vs DC 17 first. On success, fill in the alcove from the current layout. On failure: "The snack crumbs and old smells muddle your nose. You cannot isolate an alcove." Surge spent; no reset.

> "alive?" → Scooby's snout twitches into overdrive. Alcove ___ smells like a wet swamp monster that just ate a meatloaf. Something in there is breathing.
> "fake?" → Alcove ___ smells of... nothing at all. Not metal, not dust. It's like the key isn't there.

ENVELOPE 3 · THE MENAGERIE PLAQUE

Hand this to the players.

> Four keys wait, and three are lies.
> What casts no true shadow, the sun will expose;
> What lives will choke where the venom blows;
> What ticks, the acid melts from within;
> One breath, one drop: spend them, then win.
> Touch none with your hand. Let the ghost hand begin.

ENVELOPE 4 · MURRAY'S BANDAGE TAP (READ ALOUD)

Prompt: "Murray, your Bandage Whip reaches 2 squares. Want to tap the pedestals, without touching the keys?" Fill in from the current layout.

> Tap... Alcove ___ lets out an irritated, wet snore. Tap... Alcove ___ gives a faint clockwork tick-tick-tick. Tap... the whip passes straight through the key in Alcove ___. Tap... Alcove ___ rings like a pure, hollow brass bell.

ENVELOPE 5 · EVIDENCE CARD E4: THE MIMIC'S SNACK

Goes in with Crest #4.

> Stuck between the mimic's needle teeth: a tuft of hair stained bright **purple**.